RESTORE ALL PUNCTUATIONS MARKS

I have a dream is a public speech delivered by American civil rights activist Martin Luther King Jnr during the march on Washington for jobs and freedom on August 28 1963 in which he calls for an end to racism in the United States and called for civil and economic rights delivered to over 250000 civil rights supporters from the steps of the Lincoln Memorial in Washington, D.C. the speech was a defining moment of the civil rights movement.

Beginning with a reference to the Emancipation Proclamation which freed millions of slaves in 1863 King observed one hundred years later the Negro still is not free. Toward the end of the speech King departed from his prepared text for a partly improvised peroration on the theme I have a dream, prompted by Mahalia Jacksons cry tell them about the dream, Martin in this part of the speech, which most excited the listeners and has now become its most famous, King described his dreams of freedom and equality arising from a land of slavery and hatred. Jon Meacham writes With a single phrase Martin Luther King Jr. joined Jefferson and Lincoln in the ranks of men who have shaped modern America. The speech was ranked the top American speech of the 20th century in a 1999 poll of scholars of public address.